

The proposed law would require employers to continue to pay tipped workers the difference between the state minimum wage and the total amount a tipped worker receives in hourly wages plus tips through the end of 2028. The proposed law would also permit employers to calculate this difference over the entire weekly or bi-weekly payroll period. The requirement to pay this difference would cease when the required hourly wage for tipped workers would become 100% of the state minimum wage on January 1, 2029.

Under the proposed law, if an employer pays its workers an hourly wage that is at least the state minimum wage, the employer would be permitted to administer a “tip pool” that combines all the tips given by customers to tipped workers and distributes them among all the workers, including non-tipped workers.

A YES VOTE would increase the minimum hourly wage an employer must pay a tipped worker to the full state minimum wage implemented over five years, at which point employers could pool all tips and distribute them to all non-management workers.

A NO VOTE would make no change in the law governing tip pooling or the minimum wage for tipped workers.

Hereof fail not and make return of this warrant with your doings thereon at the time and place of said voting.

YES: 309

NO: 929

BLANKS: 28

The polls closed at 8:00 p.m. Tabulation and counting began immediately with Christine Mardirosian, Karen Harper, Edna Holloway, Sherry Bergin, Tammy Gehring , Norma Mann and Rebecca Wilkie. Counting ended at 9:00 p.m. Unofficial Results posted.

SPECIAL TOWN MEETING VOTES MARCH 11, 2025

A quorum being present, Moderator Dennis Bergin called the meeting to order at 7:09 p.m.

Article 1: It was voted by a majority vote to appropriate \$15,000 from the Assessors Stabilization account to the Assessors revaluation line-item account.

Article 2: It was voted by a majority vote to transfer from Free Cash, the following amounts to the following accounts:

Police Dept: \$6,000 to the training salary account.

Fire Dept: \$4,000 to the training/wages account.

Town Clerk: \$2,500 to the election’s workers wage account.

Town Clerk: \$2,894.49 to the election expense account.
Board of Selectmen: \$3,000 to the Admin Asst wage account.
Board of Selectmen: \$2,000 to the Administrative account.
Town Counsel: \$2,000 to the Town Counsel account.

The meeting adjourned at 7:18 p.m.

ANNUAL TOWN ELECTION MAY 19, 2025

The polls were opened at 10:00 P.M. by Christine Mardirosian and closed at 8: P.M. by Christine Mardirosian. The Election Officer on duty was Christine Mardirosian.

On duty were:

Christine Mardirosian	8:30 A.M. to 9:00 P.M.
Janice Handrahan	9:00 A.M. to 8:45 P.M.
Marissa Savary	9:30 A.M. to 3:30 P.M.
Norma Mann	9:45 A.M. to 8:45 P.M.
Catherine Corcoran	9:30 A.M. to 2:00 P.M.
Wendy LeBlanc	12:00 P.M. to 8:45 P.M.
Judith Noonon	2:00 P.M. to 7:30 P.M.
Karen Harper	3:00 P.M. to 9:00 P.M.

Official Ballots

Official ballots delivered to polls	800
Official ballots spoiled	8
Official ballots cast	550
Official ballots Not Cast	242
No. of Provisional ballots	0
No. of test ballots and were tested	25

Early Voting Ballots

Early Voting ballots delivered to polls	200
Early Voting ballots spoiled	0
Early Voting ballots cast	43
Early Voting ballots not Cast	150
Early Voting ballots not returned	7

Total number of ballots cast	593
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Total number of names checked on voter list	593
Total number of voters eligible to vote	1,561

Selectmen 3 Year Term

Dennis M Bergin Jr.	347
Aaron L Langlois	245
All Other	
Blanks	1

Board of Assessor 3 Year Term

Diane M Peterson	467
All Others	7
Blanks	119

Board of Assessor 1 Year Term

Susan Turnbull	60
All Others	5
Blanks	528

Board of Health 3 Year Term

Write-ins	
Aaron Langlois	8
Mark Mirabella	5
Susan Turnbull	4
All Others	5
Blanks	571

Board of Health 2 Year Term

Elizabeth F Weeks	465
All Others	3
Blanks	125

Library Trustee 3 Year Term

Lisa D Huntington	476
All Others	6
Blanks	111

Cemetery Commission 3 Year Term

John P Dymon Jr.	467
All Others	7
Blanks	119

Constables 3 Year Term

Sherry A Bergin	434
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Denise R Collett	412
Tammy J Gehring	450
Fred Jean-Francois	397
Lucy I Tessnau	396
All Others	9

Planning Board 5 Year Term

Barbara A Piucci	159
Phillip B Warbasse	418
All Others	1
Blanks	15

ANNUAL TOWN MEETING VOTES JUNE 24, 2025

A quorum being present, Moderator Dennis Bergin called the meeting to order at 7:05 p.m.

Article 1: It was voted to pass over this article.

To see if the Town will accept reports of Town Officers as printed in the Annual Town Report; or take any action relative thereto.

Article 2: It was voted to fix the salaries and compensation of all Elected Officers of the Town as provided for by Chapter 41 Section 108, of the General Laws of the Commonwealth.

Article 3: It was voted to authorize the Treasurer, with the approval of the Board of Selectmen, to borrow in anticipation of revenue for the twelve-month period beginning July 1, 2025, and to renew any note or notes as may be given for a period of less than one year.

Article 4: It was voted to authorize the Board of Selectmen to enter into agreements with the Commonwealth of Massachusetts Department of Transportation for the construction, reconstruction, and improvement of Town roads.

Article 5: It was voted to authorize the Board of Selectmen to set compensation that will allow for men and equipment used in repairing highways and opening roads for enginemen and/or firemen employed for the purpose of fire protection and for police officers employed for the purpose of police protection, during the fiscal year beginning July 1, 2025.

Article 6: It was voted to accept any sum of money received from the Commonwealth of Massachusetts pursuant to the provisions of Chapter 90 of the Massachusetts General Laws and authorize the Treasurer to expend such funds for the purposes authorized, including maintaining, repairing, improving and constructing ways,

up to the reimbursable amount according to the provisions of said Chapter 90, said funds to be spent with the approval of the Board of Selectmen and Mass. Department of Transportation.

Article 7: It was voted to establish annual expenditure limits for Fiscal Year 2026, for all revolving funds listed in section 23.7 of the Revolving Fund bylaw, Chapter 23 of the General Bylaws, as set forth below in Article 7.

Board of Health	\$20,000
Building Inspector	\$50,000
Plumbing Inspector	\$5,000
Wire Inspector	\$50,000
Deputy Collector	\$8,000
Planning Board	\$5,000
Zoning Appeals Board	\$3,000
Treasurer- MLC fees	\$5,000
Council on Aging	\$10,000
Fire Dept Training	\$25,000

Article 8: It was voted to raise and appropriate \$4,628,289.10 and to transfer \$158,000 from free cash, for a total appropriation of \$4,957,711.08 as is necessary to pay salaries, expenses, and outlays of the several town departments and to be allocated as itemized in the table shown in Article 8 for the fiscal year beginning July 1, 2025.

FY26 Town of Oakham Budget			
Department	Expense Type	FY25 Budget	FY26 Budget Recommendation
Ambulance	Total Expenses	\$ 27,500.00	\$ 28,00.00
Board of Assessors	Total Salaries, Wages & Stipend	\$ 23,819.00	\$ 24,819.00
Board of Assessors	Total Expenses	\$ 10,636.00	\$ 10,344.00
Board of Assessors Revaluation	Total Revaluation Expenses	\$ 6,700.00	\$ 8,800.00